



FY2025 Expense Management

Budget vs. Actual Performance Review & Interactive Dashboard



Business Problem

Finance was tracking 250+ expense transactions across 4 regions, 6 departments, and 8 categories in disconnected spreadsheets — with no fast way to see where spend was outpacing budget.

- No single view of budget vs. actual across regions, departments, and categories
- Variance and overspend were only discovered after month-end close
- Approval status (Approved / Pending / Rejected) wasn't visible to budget owners
- Manual SUM/COUNT work in Excel took hours and was error-prone

250

Transactions Logged

4

Regions

6

Departments

8

Expense Categories



Total budget, total actual, variance %, average transaction, approval rate, transaction count

Budget vs. actual by region & department, monthly trend, category mix, and approval-status split

Filter dropdowns for Region, Department, and Status, with a live filtered total and count

Any budget owner can filter to their region or department and see performance in seconds.



Key Insights



+2.1% Over Budget

Actual spend of \$625,941 exceeded the \$612,904 budget by \$13,037 across all 250 transactions.



Marketing & Sales Drive Overruns

Marketing (+8.6%) and Sales (+5.6%) posted the largest percentage overruns of any department.



IT & HR Under Budget

IT (−0.3%) and HR (−1.5%) were the only two departments to finish under budget.



30% of Transactions Not Yet Approved

Only 70% of transactions carry “Approved” status — a possible workflow bottleneck.



Recommendations

1

Tighten spend controls in Marketing & Sales

Require pre-approval above a set threshold in the two departments with the largest overruns.

2

Clear the approval backlog

Audit the 30% of pending/rejected transactions to remove workflow bottlenecks.

3

Review Salaries & Consulting costs

These are the largest dollar-value categories, so small % overruns carry outsized budget impact.

4

Scale IT & HR's cost discipline

Use their under-budget practices as a model, and set monthly variance alerts (>5%) via the dashboard.

Next step: review the dashboard filters together to prioritize which region or department to address first.